Their common aversions are strengthened by the fact that all the BRICS today are sovereignty hawks, although the intensity of this preference varies among the five.[29] The BRICS' shared aversion to U.S. hegemonic practices and Western double standards ranges widely across many policy arenas, from the unilateral use of force and financial sanctions to using informal leverage, bending or skirting the formal rules of international institutions, or guaranteeing themselves unfair exceptions and privileges. For example, emerging powers share an antipathy to the proclivity by Western countries to support intervention in the name of humanitarian missions in the post–Cold War period. Even the BRICS democracies, which support human rights and humanitarian intervention under constrained circumstances, are wary of a principle that can be used as a pretext to meddle in their domestic affairs. The authoritarian BRICS warn that "backwardness invites bullies," and of the risk of the West instigating "color revolutions" to overthrow established regimes in their neighborhoods or against themselves.[30]

Although they all benefit from the current international economic order, each of the BRICS is a major power within its own geographic region and has a strong desire to become the dominant regional power. Such preferences incentivize them to share a wariness of "infringements on their autonomy and precedents that limit their freedom to set their own policy agendas."[31] However, regional powers are inherently constrained under conditions of international unipolarity, given the American stance that "the world is the unipole's neighborhood."[32] Competition between the United States and rising regional powers involves distributional conflict,[33] and the natural preference of regional actors is to operate independent of American power and purpose. Hence, regionalism provides a "space for a variety of counter-hegemonic projects."[34] Among the prominent examples in the case of BRICS are Russia's and especially China's promotion of their currencies as regional substitutes for the U.S. dollar in cross-border trade and bilateral swap agreements.

Common aversions also reflect the powerful incentive for all BRICS states in the area of financial statecraft, where they converge on a preference for autonomy and protecting national policy discretion from U.S. financial leverage and structural power as exercised through the International Monetary Fund (IMF) or by controlling access to the global banking system.[35] All the BRICS share a common aversion to the use of